



You may also search for variable and class usages – an invaluable asset when you want to remove an old file or legacy class/function from your codebase. Note: When you move files from one directory to another, all references to the file path (includes, mentions, file_open calls, etc.) automatically get updated.

Want to have a quick getter or setter method for a class member? Right-click the variable and select 'Generate'. The rest is quite easy. You can also pull/push members down the class hierarchy tree. So if you wrote a wrapper which you think can go into that class' parent class, just right-click

No, you don't have to take full backup of your server, zip files on your laptop, upload them to the server, unzip them and then reconfigure the server. Configure the automatic deployment option in Tools > Deployment > Configuration and that's about it. Next time, you want to make a change, right-click the file(s) in the project explorer and say 'upload'. Thou shalt be done on the server! You could map individual directories and ignore some from being uploaded, e.g. a 'tests' directory might not be needed on the server.

If you're tracking your code with revision tools such as Subversion, Git, Mercurial etc.,

are cool and useful, but writing commands on a prompt can be tiring. PhpStorm comes with a built-in GUI for a number of code revision systems. If it detects your project to be a working copy for one, it will notify you. Go to Project Settings > Version Control > Choose your VCS and configure your project. Thereafter, the built-in GUI will follow all your work. You can have passwords set up for your GitHub and Bitbucket accounts, too. Pushing to remotes and other actions such as committing, rebasing, branch managements, tracking, pull, push, merge, comparison etc. are made available from the VCS menu at the top. Finally, PhpStorm features a 'diff' viewing feature that lets you go back in history and visually see the differences between commits.

Set your style of coding

When it comes to coding, everyone has personal preference regarding spaces, commas, newlines, brackets and what not. Tell PhpStorm about these preferences in File > Settings > Project Settings > Code Style and once you're done, all code indentations will obey your rules.

Change the interface theme

Don't like the default black theme? You can change the IDE's UI in the settings window under IDE Settings > Appearance. Open a terminal

If you need the terminal for some task, go to Tools > Open Terminal and one will open up at the bottom of the IDE. This feature works on all supported platforms. You can click on '+' button on the Terminal interface at the bottom to open more than one terminal session at once.

Not only does PhpStorm understand various languages,

it also understands frameworks. If you're using a popular Open Source framework, chances are you're pretty well covered by PhpStorm's intelligence.

Surround code with constructs

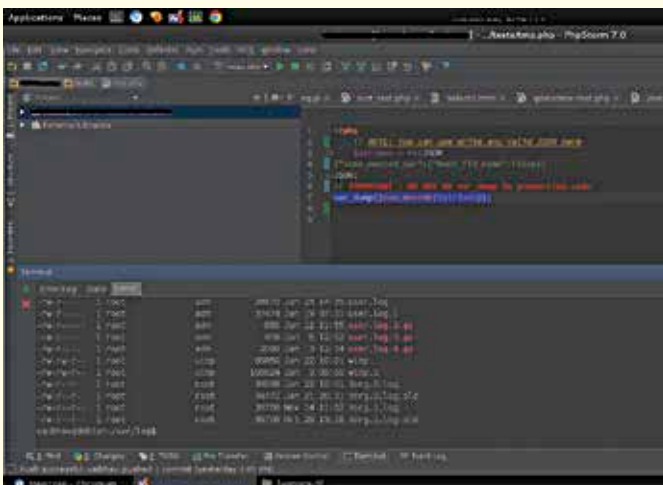
So you wrote an expression and now want it inside braces? Select the text and hit [Ctrl]+[Alt]+[T] and you'll get a menu which lets you select the type of construct you want to surround the selected text with. Want to wrap text inside an if, or if-else condition or ensure robustness by placing it inside a try-catch block? Options unfold when you press that key combination.

Set custom colors for certain comments

Being a developer means having a long list of things at hand to do, remember and take note of. Most IDEs offer a different color for 'todo' comments (comments that start with 'todo'). PhpStorm goes a step ahead and gives you additional formatting options to create more colored comments. For example, you can have comments beginning with 'note' to appear in orange, italics and underlined with dots OR have comments beginning with 'urgent' to appear in red and bold and so on. To set those up, go to Settings > IDE Settings > Todo > Add or edit existing patterns and their color formats

Set custom key binding for events

There is a possibility that PhpStorm's own key binding conflicts with your OS's key bindings. To cite one, the 'surround code with' shortcut [Alt]+[Ctrl]+[T] would open a terminal window on Ubuntu. You can change these in Settings > IDE settings > Keymap



Terminal is accessible at the bottom in PhpStorm

the class name and then go to Refactor > Select the pull/push action on the members of the class members. If there's a variable you created once and now, for performance reasons, want to make its value be inline on all points of usage, refactoring features of PhpStorm will come to your aid again. The number of features are jaw-dropping.

Automate deployments

So you have a site that's working the way you want and you want to alter a file (or update multiple files to bring in a new feature)?

PhpStorm will show only the changed files in the 'Changes' toolbox (button at the bottom of the IDE interface). You can choose to upload the complete set of changed files in exactly three clicks. It maintains a copy of files deployed on the server so if the contents on the server were changed after your last push, you can either ask your team-mates if they pushed an update or panic because someone overwrote a file on the server without you knowing about it.

Familiarise yourself with the in-built GUIs for revision control code revision systems